Tomislav Mesarić

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BUTCHER | MEAT COUNTER ASSISTANT

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Butcher and meat counter professional with experience since 2015 in carcass breakdown, counter service and fresh sausage production. Completed vocational butcher training and hold a current HACCP basic food hygiene certificate. Experienced in advising customers, daily FIFO stock rotation, and recording cold-room and display-counter temperature checks.

CORE SKILLS

Carcass breakdown (beef, pork and lamb) | Boning, trimming and portioning | Fresh sausage making | Customer advice on cuts and cooking | FIFO stock rotation | HACCP hygiene and temperature checks | Knife sharpening | Mincer and bandsaw operation | Counter cleaning and sanitation | Cash handling | Hand pallet jack use

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Butcher | Mesnica Kod Ante (family butcher shop), Zagreb | 2019–Present

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides per week; bone, trim and portion meat for the counter.
- Make about 40 kg of fresh sausage per week in the busy season, including ćevapi, kobasice, chipolata and lamb merguez. Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the ćevapi mix to 70% beef and 30% lamb following customer feedback; the ćevapi won second place at the Zagreb County craft meat fair in 2023.
- Rotate cold-room stock every morning using FIFO, placing older stock at the front. Record cold-room (0–4 °C) and display-counter temperature checks twice daily.
- Serve about 120 customers on a Saturday and advise on cuts and cooking times.
- Train two apprentices in safe knife handling and cleaning routines.
- From 2022 to 2025, prepared whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting at three weddings and about 10 family parties a year; ordered, butchered, seasoned and delivered the meat on the event morning. Largest order: four lambs and two pigs for a 180-guest wedding in Samobor in 2024.
- Ran a six-week dry-ageing trial of beef ribs at 21 and 28 days, recording weight loss and temperature. The shop now sells dry-aged rib by pre-order, about 15 kg per month.

Counter Assistant | Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall, Zagreb | 2015–2019

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers and the counter at closing.
- Wrote a one-page closing and cleaning checklist for the slicer, mincer, counter and floor drain following a hygiene inspection remark; it remains displayed inside the cold-room door.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATES

Vocational Certificate: Butcher (3-year programme) | Food Trades School Zagreb | 2015
HACCP Basic Food Hygiene Certificate | 2021; renewed 2024
Preparing for the master butcher exam (majstorski ispit), planned for spring 2027

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) | English (good for customer communication) | German (basic)